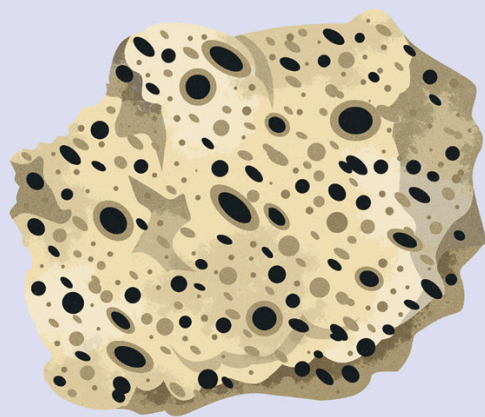




*The Ancient Romans mixed pumice
with other materials to make super-strong
concrete for their houses and temples.*

Pumice

What's that on the water? It looks like a grey blanket on the ocean waves, but move closer and you'll see it is lots of floating rocks! This is pumice. Pumice is full of holes filled with gas, which makes it so light that it can float on water.

Where did the rocks come from though? Pumice is a volcanic glass. Sometimes, when lava erupts from a volcano it can be full of gas bubbles, like a fizzy drink. As the red-hot foam cools, it hardens into pumice, and the bubbles leave lots of little pockets. If a seabed volcano erupts, it makes pumice underwater, which floats to the surface as a pumice raft. Mystery solved!

